

# Diagnostic Breath Analyses

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## Tracking Information

### Publication Number

100-3

### Manual Section Number

100.5

### Manual Section Title

Diagnostic Breath Analyses

### Version Number

1

### Effective Date of this Version

06/12/1984

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## Description Information

### Benefit Category

Diagnostic Tests (other)

**Please Note:** This may not be an exhaustive list of all applicable Medicare benefit categories for this item or service.

### Item/Service Description

Diagnostic breath analyses are tests performed to measure either the hydrogen or carbon dioxide content of the breath after the ingestion of certain compounds. The analyses are performed to diagnose certain gastrointestinal disease states.

Indications and Limitations of Coverage

The Following Breath Test is Covered:

- Lactose breath hydrogen to detect lactose malabsorption.

The Following Breath Tests are Excluded from Coverage:

- Lactulose breath hydrogen for diagnosing small bowel bacterial overgrowth and measuring small bowel transit time.
- CO2 for diagnosing bile acid malabsorption.
- CO2 for diagnosing fat malabsorption.

Additional Information

Other Versions

| Title                      | Version | Effective Between |  |
|----------------------------|---------|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Diagnostic Breath Analyses | 1       | 06/12/1984 - N/A  | You are here                                                                        |